

# Rooted FC: How Trees Help Rainwater Score



## THE AIM

Get the rain into the ground, where it can feed soil, plants, streams and springs later.

## THE DANGER

On bare compacted ground, rain runs off the pitch before it gets a chance to score.

## Team Sheet

### **Leaves United**

Leaves defend against the attack of raindrops and stop the soil being smashed into a hard crust.

### **Stem City**

Stems and trunks control midfield, slowing the match down and guiding water safely towards the ground.

### **Root Madrid**

Roots attack the soil, opening channels and creating the scoring chances for water to go underground.

### **Worms Albion**

Worms, fungi, insects and microbes coach from below, building tunnels and helping the whole team play better.

### **Soil Trafford**

Healthy soil is the goalmouth. A good goal holds water after the match and releases it slowly later.

### **Runoff Rovers**

Bare compacted ground loses possession. Water races downhill, carries soil away, and leaves the pitch.

## **Humans Are the Manager**

The manager cannot kick every ball. Their job is to choose the team shape: where to plant, where to protect young trees, where to keep animals off while roots grow, and where to watch what happens after rain.

### **Field Challenge**

Stand on a slope after rain and ask:

- Where is water running away fastest?
- Where is the ground bare, hard or compacted?
- Where are trees, roots or rough grass already slowing water down?
- Where would you put your next defender?

**Rain is the ball. Leaves defend. Roots attack. Soil is the goal.  
Humans manage the team.**